Pāhala Large Capacity Cesspool Closure

The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency in 2000 published a rule requiring the closure of all existing large capacity cesspools (LCCs) by April 5, 2005. In Kaʻū, the sugar plantation company C. Brewer built and operated large capacity cesspools connected to properties in Pāhala and Nāʻālehu. In 2003, C. Brewer requested assistance from the County of Hawaiʻi to close the large capacity cesspools. In 2010, the County of Hawai'i agreed to assume ownership of the existing collection system and large capacity cesspools with the goal of constructing a new and improved wastewater treatment system for Pāhala and Nāʻālehu. In furtherance of those goals the County of Hawaiʻi, under the Administrative Order on Consent issued in 2017, revised in 2022 and again in 2024, is closing the large capacity cesspools in Pāhala and Nāʻālehu.

PĀHALA PROJECT

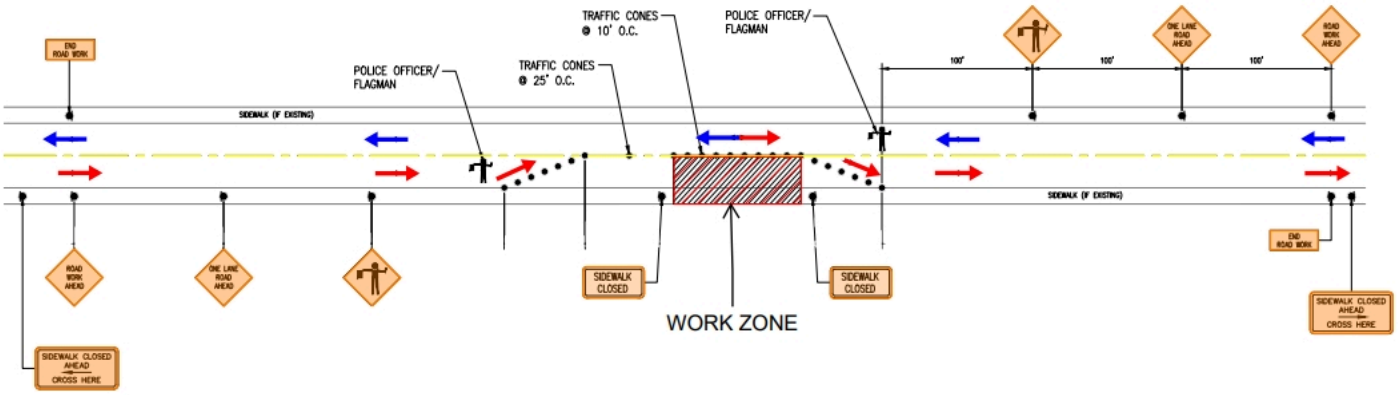
COLLECTION SYSTEM TIMELINE

CONSTRUCTION START	CONSTRUCTION END	COLLECTION SYSTEM OPERATIONAL	DEADLINE TO CLOSE LCCs
7/7/2025	5/11/2026	TBD	1/22/2027

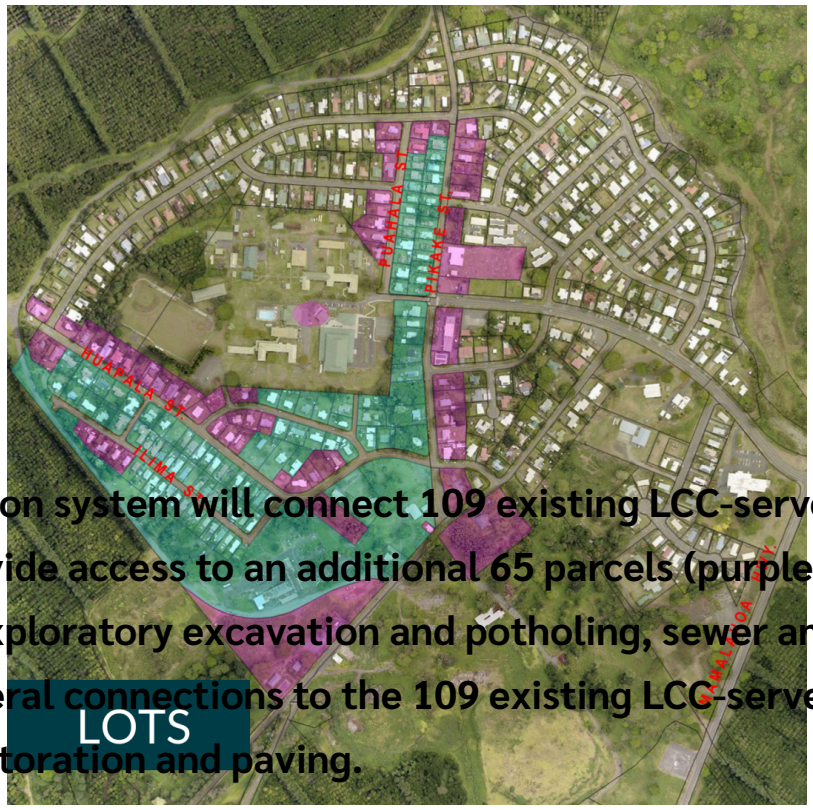
PROJECT UPDATES

- A Notice to Proceed for the construction of the Pāhala Wastewater Treatment Plant was issued on March 6, 2026 to Alpha Inc with a beginning date of March 16, 2026.
- A semi annual public meeting was held Thursday February 19th, 2026 at 6:00 p.m. at the Pāhala Community Center (96-1149 Kamani St.)
- On February 4th, a Notice of Award was issued for the construction of the Pāhala Wastewater Treatment Plant.
- A quarterly meeting with the EPA was held on January 20th, 2026.
- As of October 9th, 2025 the solicitation for the construction of the Pāhala Wastewater Treatment Plant was closed. The County is currently evaluating proposals.
- Construction of the wastewater collection system is ongoing and is approximately 20% complete as of January 21st, 2026.

For weekly updates on areas of work and traffic control, please click here to visit the Goodfellow Bros. project page.



PLANNED IMPROVEMENTS



The new collection system will connect 109 existing LCC-served properties (green) and provide access to an additional 65 parcels (purple). Construction work includes exploratory excavation and potholing, sewer and water line installation, lateral connections to the 109 existing LCC-served properties, and roadway restoration and paving.

Wastewater from the new system will eventually be routed to a centralized treatment plant. Bid solicitation for construction starts on June 30, 2025.

FAQs

Who was the project awarded to?

The County has awarded a $30.9 million contract to Goodfellow Bros. The contractor is responsible for building the new collection system.

What happens to the wastewater once it enters the new system?

Wastewater will be routed to a centralized treatment plant. That facility will be constructed as a separate project.

Is this a legally mandated project?

Yes. The project is part of the County's obligations under an Administrative Order on Consent (AOC) with the EPA. Visit our Regulatory Documents and Filings page to view all documents.

How can the public track compliance?

Visit our Regulatory Documents and Filings page to view compliance reports and other documents.

When is the next public meeting?

The next semiannual meeting for both communities will be held Thursday February 19, 2026 at 6:00 p.m. at the Pāhala Community Center (96-1149 Kamani St).

CONTACT US

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